complete plan in the event of a nuclear attack.

There are many aspects of the report, which I'd requested of the Pentagon two years earlier, that remain so secret even now that I cannot even begin to discuss them. But, simply put, it was a scenario for a sequence of events that could lead to the end of civilization as we knew it.

In several ways, the sequence of events described in the briefings paralleled those in the ABC movie. Yet there were still some people at the Pentagon who claimed a nuclear war was "winnable." I thought they were crazy. Worse, it appeared there were also Soviet generals who thought in terms of winning a nuclear war.

Several weeks later, convinced we had to do everything possible to develop a defense against the horrible weapons of mass destruction that the atomic age had produced, I gave a go-ahead to speed up research on the Strategic Defense Initiative, noting in the diary:

> Some 50 scientists were persuaded to look at the problem after my March 23, 1983, declaration. They started as skeptics and have wound up enthusiastic. We'll proceed.

A few weeks after the Korean airliner was shot down, the parliaments of Great Britain, Italy, and West Germany reaffirmed their intention to deploy Pershing II and Tomahawk cruise missiles in Europe, and we began hearing rumors the Soviets were going to walk out of the INF negotiations in a bid to court favorable public opinion in Europe. "Some on our side want us to come up with an additional proposal," I wrote in the diary.

> That is a lousy negotiating strategy. It's time for the Soviets to come up with a proposal of their own. We can't keep changing our proposals every time they say